

- **Fundamentals of Social Work in Islam — Short Notes with Quranic Translations**

Introduction

- Islam is a complete code of life covering social, political, economic, and moral aspects.
 - Social work in Islam is not optional; it is a religious obligation.
 - Helping humanity is considered an act of worship.
 - Islam promotes equality, justice, brotherhood, tolerance, and welfare.
-

- **Social Work**

Definition

Social work is a professional activity that helps individuals, families, groups, and communities improve their social functioning and living conditions.

Main Functions

- Helping people obtain services
- Counseling and guidance
- Improving social conditions
- Promoting justice and welfare

Main Philosophy

- Empower weak and helpless people
 - Support underprivileged groups
 - Promote equality and justice
-

- **Islam and Social Work**

Core Principles of Islam

Islam is based on two major principles:

1. Worship Allah
2. Serve humanity

A Muslim's worship is incomplete without helping others.

- **Quranic Teachings About Social Welfare**

Surah Al-Baqarah (2:177)

Main Idea

True righteousness is not only worship but also helping humanity.

Translation

“Righteousness is not that you turn your faces toward east or west, but true righteousness is to believe in Allah, the Last Day, the Angels, the Books, and the Prophets; and to give wealth, despite loving it, to relatives, orphans, the needy, travelers, those who ask for help, and for freeing slaves.”

Important Points

- Help relatives
 - Support orphans
 - Assist poor and needy
 - Help travelers
 - Charity is part of faith
-

Surah An-Nisa (4:36)

Translation

“Worship Allah and associate nothing with Him, and show kindness to parents, relatives, orphans, the needy, near neighbors, distant neighbors, companions, travelers, and those under your care.”

Main Message

- Worship must include kindness toward society.
 - Muslims should care for all people around them.
-

- **Hadith About Social Welfare**

Sharing Food

“When you make broth, add more water and give some to your neighbor.”

Lesson

- Care for neighbors
 - Share resources
-

Helping Others

“Whoever removes a hardship from a believer, Allah will remove his hardship on the Day of Judgment.”

Lesson

- Helping people brings reward from Allah.
 - Allah helps those who help others.
-

Guiding Toward Good

“Whoever calls people toward righteousness will receive reward like those who follow him.”

Lesson

- Social reform and guidance are rewarded continuously.
-

Continuous Charity

“The best things a man leaves behind are: a righteous child, ongoing charity, and beneficial knowledge.”

Lesson

Good deeds continue benefiting a person after death.

- **Fundamentals of Social Work in Islam**

Five Pillars of Islam

1. Shahadah (Faith)
 2. Salah (Prayer)
 3. Zakat (Charity)
 4. Sawm (Fasting)
 5. Hajj (Pilgrimage)
-

- **Zakat**

Definition

Mandatory charity paid by financially stable Muslims.

Purpose

- Redistributes wealth
- Helps poor people
- Reduces poverty
- Creates economic balance
- Promotes social welfare

Importance of Zakat

- Mentioned about 80 times in the Quran.
 - Abu Bakr fought tribes refusing to pay Zakat, showing its importance.
-

- **Social Impact of Zakat**

Individual Impact

- Purifies wealth and soul
- Develops kindness
- Strengthens faith
- Encourages generosity
- Builds responsibility

Collective/Societal Impact

- Social justice
 - Social security
 - Wealth circulation
 - Brotherhood and tolerance
 - Peace and prosperity
 - Reduction of begging
 - Increase in self-respect
-

- **Surah Al-Baqarah (2:83)**

Translation

“Worship none except Allah, be good to parents, relatives, orphans, and the needy, speak kindly to people, establish prayer, and give Zakat.”

Main Message

- Islam combines worship with social welfare.
 - Good behavior toward society is essential.
-

- **Other Forms of Charity**

Sadaqah

Voluntary charity for helping others.

Khairat

General financial help for needy people.

Fitrah

Mandatory yearly charity after Ramadan.

- **Rewards of Good Deeds**

Surah Al-An'am (6:160)

Translation

“Whoever comes with a good deed will have ten times the like of it.”

Main Message

Allah rewards every good action greatly.

Surah An-Naml (27:89)

Translation

“Whoever comes with a good deed will have better than it and will be safe from fear on that Day.”

Surah Az-Zalzalah (99:7)

Translation

“Whoever does even an atom's weight of good will see it.”

Main Message

Every small good deed matters.

- **Welfare Beyond Humans**

Islam encourages kindness toward:

- Animals
- Nature
- Environment

Hadith

“If a Muslim plants a tree and a bird, person, or animal eats from it, it is counted as charity for him.”

Lesson

Helping any living being is rewarded.

- **Islam and Social Work Similarities**

Both focus on:

- Human dignity
 - Justice
 - Helping vulnerable people
 - Anti-oppression
 - Welfare and empowerment
-

- **Bait-ul-Mal**

Definition

Islamic public treasury.

Functions

- Collects charity and Zakat
 - Distributes wealth among deserving people
 - Supports poor and disabled individuals
-

- **Islamic Principles and Society**

Goals

- Eliminate poverty
 - Promote justice
 - Ensure equality
 - Create peaceful society
 - Encourage brotherhood and tolerance
 - Protect rights of women, elderly, and weak people
-

- **Surah Al-Ma'idah (5:2)**

Translation

“Help one another in righteousness and piety, and do not help one another in sin and transgression.”

Main Message

- Muslims should cooperate in good deeds.
 - Islam forbids social evils and oppression.
-

- **Respect for Parents and Elderly**

Surah Al-Ankabut (29:8)

Translation

“We have instructed man to be kind to his parents.”

Main Message

Islam gives special importance to parents and elderly people.

- **Key Features of Islamic Social Work**
- Service to humanity is worship.
- Helping others is compulsory.
- Wealth should circulate fairly.
- Every good deed is rewarded.
- Welfare applies to all humans regardless of religion.

- Islam promotes peace, justice, and equality.
-

- **Conclusion**

- Islam provides a complete social welfare system.
 - Social work includes financial, moral, and social responsibilities.
 - Following Islamic principles creates:
 - Justice
 - Equality
 - Peace
 - Brotherhood
 - Prosperity
 - Islam encourages Muslims to help every living being.
-

- **Important One-Line Revision Points**

- Social work in Islam is an obligation, not an option.
- Zakat is the foundation of Islamic social welfare.
- Helping humanity is considered worship.
- Islam promotes justice, equality, and brotherhood.
- Charity purifies wealth and society.
- Every good deed is rewarded by Allah.
- Islam encourages kindness toward humans and animals alike.